

BIRDS

CLASS Aves

BULLOCKS ORIOLE



Birds are the only members of the phylum Chordata that possess feathers. They use them to keep warm and, in most cases, to fly. Birds are closely related to reptiles, and form a single clade (p.20) with them and the now-extinct dinosaurs. In recent years, comparison of DNA from different species of birds has led to many changes in avian classification, with the system used in this book separating the class into 40 orders. Some bird orders are very small: the ostrich order, for example, contains just 2 species, while that

containing the mousebirds has only 6. By comparison, the order containing the passeriformes, or perching birds, contains more species (over 6,000) than all the other orders combined, and it includes all the world's songbirds. Within this huge order, there is considerable disagreement about how many families of passerine birds there are. Some ornithologists consider that there are just 60 families, but many of the larger ornithological societies are moving toward a system that recognizes more than 130 families.

TINAMOUS

ORDER Tinamiformes FAMILIES 1 SPECIES 47

OSTRICH

ORDER Struthioniformes FAMILIES 1 SPECIES 2

RHEAS

ORDER Rheiformes FAMILIES 1 SPECIES 2

CASSOWARIES AND EMUS

ORDER Casuariiformes FAMILIES 2 SPECIES 4

KIWIS

ORDER Apterygiformes FAMILIES 1 SPECIES 5

WATERFOWL

ORDER Anseriformes FAMILIES 3 SPECIES 177

GAMEBIRDS

ORDER Galliformes FAMILIES 5 SPECIES 299

DIVERS

ORDER Gaviiformes FAMILIES 1 SPECIES 6

PENGUINS

ORDER Sphenisciformes FAMILIES 1 SPECIES 18

ALBATROSSES AND PETRELS

ORDER Procellariiformes FAMILIES 4 SPECIES 147

GREBES

ORDER Podicipediformes FAMILIES 1 SPECIES 23

FLAMINGOS

ORDER Phoenicopteriformes FAMILIES 1 SPECIES 6

TROPICBIRDS

ORDER Phaethontiformes FAMILIES 1 SPECIES 3

STORKS

ORDER Ciconiiformes FAMILIES 1 SPECIES 19

HERONS AND RELATIVES

ORDER Pelecaniformes FAMILIES 5 SPECIES 118

GANNETS, CORMORANTS, AND RELATIVES

ORDER Suliformes FAMILIES 4 SPECIES 60

HAWKS, EAGLES, AND RELATIVES

ORDER Accipitriformes FAMILIES 4 SPECIES 265

BUSTARDS

ORDER Otidiformes FAMILIES 1 SPECIES 26

MESITES

ORDER Mesitornithiformes FAMILIES 1 SPECIES 3

SERIEMAS

ORDER Cariamiformes FAMILIES 1 SPECIES 2

KAGU AND SUNBITTERN

ORDER Eurypygiiformes FAMILIES 2 SPECIES 2

RAILS, CRANES, AND RELATIVES

ORDER Gruiformes FAMILIES 6 SPECIES 189

WADERS, GULLS, AND AUKS

ORDER Charadriiformes FAMILIES 19 SPECIES 384

SANDGROUSE

ORDER Pteroclidiformes FAMILIES 1 SPECIES 16

PIGEONS

ORDER Columbiformes FAMILIES 1 SPECIES 342

HOATZIN

ORDER Opisthocomiformes FAMILIES 1 SPECIES 1

TURACOS

ORDER Musophagiformes FAMILIES 1 SPECIES 23

CUCKOOS

ORDER Cuculiformes FAMILIES 1 SPECIES 149

OWLS

ORDER Strigiformes FAMILIES 4 SPECIES 242

NIGHTJARS AND FROGMOUTHS

ORDER Caprimulgiformes FAMILIES 4 SPECIES 123

HUMMINGBIRDS AND SWIFTS

ORDER Apodiformes FAMILIES 4 SPECIES 470

MOUSEBIRDS

ORDER Coliiformes FAMILIES 1 SPECIES 6

TROGONS

ORDER Trogoniformes FAMILIES 1 SPECIES 43

CUCKOO ROLLER

ORDER Leptosomiformes FAMILIES 1 SPECIES 1

KINGFISHERS AND RELATIVES

ORDER Coraciiformes FAMILIES 6 SPECIES 160

HOOPOES AND HORNBILLS

ORDER Bucerotiformes FAMILIES 4 SPECIES 74

WOODPECKERS AND TOUCANS

ORDER Piciformes FAMILIES 9 SPECIES 447

FALCONS AND CARACARAS

ORDER Falconiformes FAMILIES 1 SPECIES 66

PARROTS

ORDER Psittaciformes FAMILIES 4 SPECIES 397

PASSERINES

ORDER Passeriformes FAMILIES 131 SPECIES 6,430